MIA XR COLLECTIVE PITCH · ROME · 22 OCTOBER 2026

# Old Stories, New Doors

What five winters of *A Christmas Carol VR* taught us about classic IP

**Alex Coulombe**
CEO, Agile Lens: Immersive Design



YOUR SPEAKER

# Alex Coulombe

**Founder & CEO, Agile Lens: Immersive Design**

Architect turned XR-chitect who has spent the last decade building spatial experiences for the world's most ambitious clients.

Authorized Unreal Engine instructor since 2020: 300+ classes taught, 40+ courses written.

| 16 | 10 | 10 | 100+ |
|---|---|---|---|
| YEARS IN XR | YEARS OF AGILE LENS | YEARS IN UNREAL | EXPERIENCES BUILT |

ROYAL SHAKESPEARE COMPANY

CBS

FOUR SEASONS

ARLEKIN PLAYERS

WALDORF ASTORIA

# AGILE LENS

IMMERSIVE DESIGN STUDIO

EST. 2016

NYC

LINCOLN CENTER

KENNEDY CENTER

FISHER DACHS ASSOCIATES

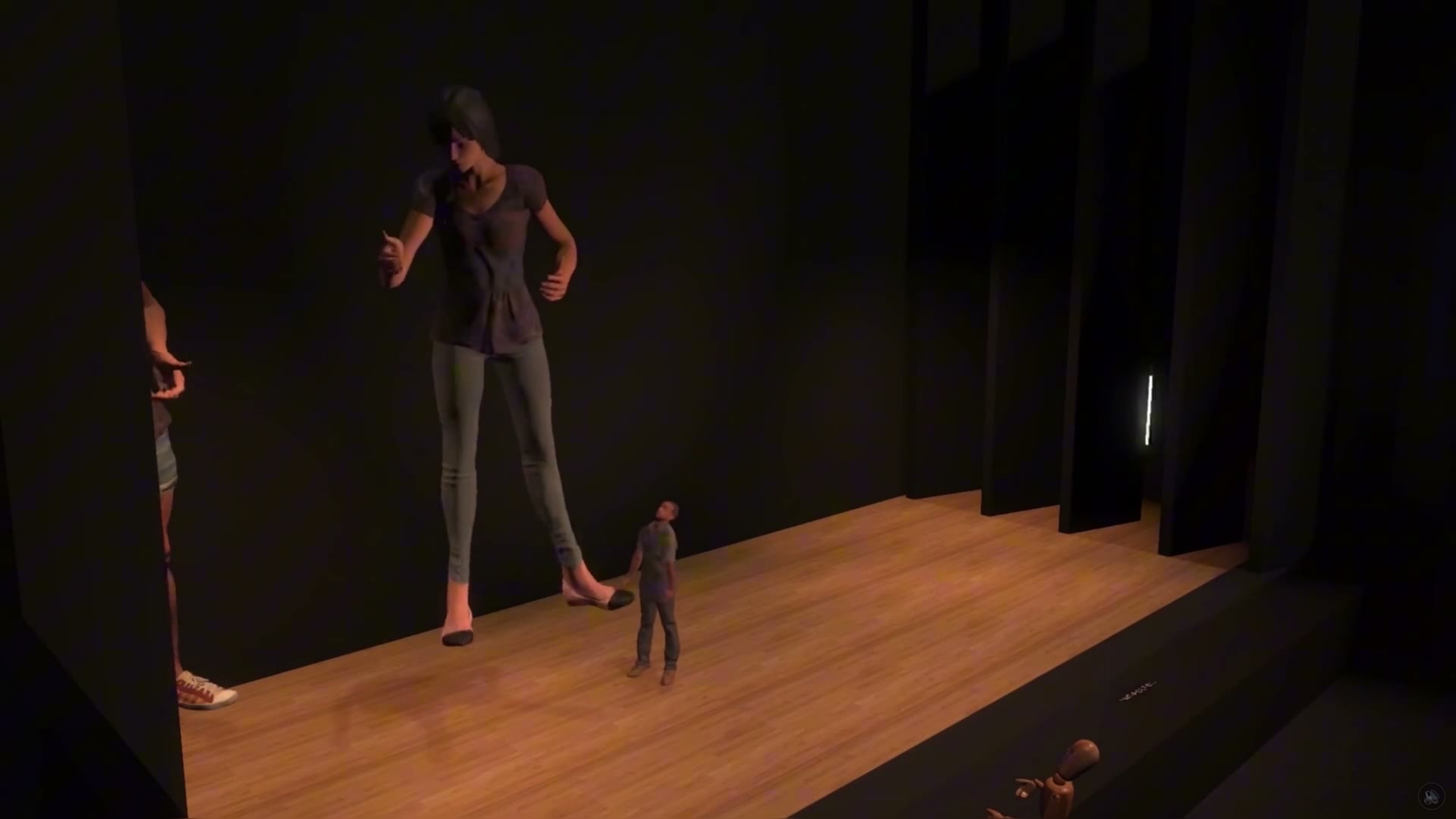
ACTORS THEATRE OF LOUISVILLE

SAMSUNG

DELL

ROYAL CARIBBEAN

BOOTSTRAPPED · XR SPECIALISTS · 10 YEARS



ACT I · 1 / 4

# Every Beloved Story Hits the Same Ceiling.

The run ends. The season closes. The house only has so many seats. The audience that loves it is getting older, and the next one needs a new way in.

Classic IP needs new audiences and new revenue beyond the stage and the screen.

IP VALUE · AUDIENCE DEVELOPMENT · NEW REVENUE




ACT I · THE CEILING

# It Started as a Small Ask

Originally produced in association with Actors Theatre of Louisville · 2021

- Actors Theatre of Louisville asked us for production assets: digital characters and some video.
- We came back with a bigger idea: a full live production of *A Christmas Carol*, in VR.
- They said yes, then gave us their blessing to remount it every year.



ACT I · THE CEILING

# A Christmas Carol VR

Live actors. Live audiences. One shared virtual stage.

- Live actors with face and full-body capture perform on the streets of a virtual Victorian London
- Fully remote: actors, crew and audience each join from wherever they are
- Five holiday seasons, 2021–2025 · The final run, December 2025: 15 performances


A Christmas Carol VR 2025 trailer · Agile Lens




ACT I · THE CEILING

# How Audiences Experienced It

Not watching a story. Standing inside one.

- Eye contact: the actor sees you, and plays the scene to you
- AI Dickens, a digital host voiced with the lead actor's permission, welcomes guests before curtain
- After the show, a live Q&A with the actors




*A Christmas Carol VR* · Agile Lens · performed live by Ari Tarr and Debbie Deer · adapted by Robert Barry Fleming

# In Their Words

Raindance Immersive 2025 nominee, Best Immersive Theatre · Audience comments as published on xmascarolvr.com, 2021–2025

"WOW doesn't even come close to describing what I just experienced! I haven't enjoyed 'A Christmas Carol' this much in years."

**Robert Copelan, audience**
xmascarolvr.com · 2024

"Each year, Agile Lens is like pushing the edge for what's next."

**Kent Bye**
Voices of VR podcast · 2025

"A Christmas Carol VR is a masterclass in acting"

**Raindance Immersive 2025 judges**
as quoted on xmascarolvr.com · 2025

"We're extremely curious to see what Agile Lens and their creators do next with theatre in VR"

**Ian Hamilton**
UploadVR, editorial · 2025

"I sat on that bench and looked up at Scrooge... and [he] emotionally spoke, of me... It felt remarkable!"

**Chuck Webster, MD, audience**
xmascarolvr.com · 2024

"This was a working glimpse into the future of VR as a medium for Real Time Live Production."

**Jimmy6DOF, audience**
xmascarolvr.com · 2021

"It was fascinating to see the affordances of VR used in this way. I'd love to see more VR plays done like this."

**Claren Naïlo, audience**
xmascarolvr.com · 2024

"Agile Lens represents a model of artistry that transcends mediums and time zones alike."

**Siobhan Greene, Instinctively Real Media**
the show's media sponsor · 2025

"The evolution of this show over the years is remarkable and the performances are top shelf!"

**Stephen Butchko, audience**
xmascarolvr.com · 2025

"Quite enjoyed catching the opening night of this. The world needs more live VR performances!"

**Nick Suda, audience**
xmascarolvr.com · 2025



ACT I · THE CEILING

# What It Proved About Classic IP

Five winters, three lessons

- A story audiences already love lowers the barrier to a brand-new format
- A live show without a building: the house can be anywhere
- The value outlived the run: characters, sets, an AI host and live-performance tools we reuse



Replay recording of a performance · Agile Lens (Yu-Jun Yeh)

ACT I · THE CEILING

# The Run Ended. The Performance Didn’t.

Our replay and film tools, and a December return

- Performances recorded with their motion capture, cues and spatial audio
- Replay from any position, on a scrub timeline: review it like dailies
- A cinematographer build shoots new camera coverage of a show that’s already over: see it in our demo area
- Back this December: the full live show as a replay, not a video, that audiences join together from headsets. Dates to be announced.

# One Performance, Four Lives

Click a stop, or drag the playhead



DECEMBER 2025

## Live in VR

Actors and audience together: 15 performances



EVERY SHOW

## Recorded as data

Motion capture, cues and spatial audio. Not video.



AFTER THE RUN

## Replayed and reshot

Any seat in the house; new camera coverage



DECEMBER 2026

## Joined together

Attendees join the replay from headsets. Dates TBA.

Live — Recorded — Reshot — Together again

ACT II · 2 / 4

# Two Ways XR Works for Film.

Inside the pipeline, where the result is still a normal film.
Or as the product: a new edition that takes the story further.

# XR Inside a Normal Film Pipeline

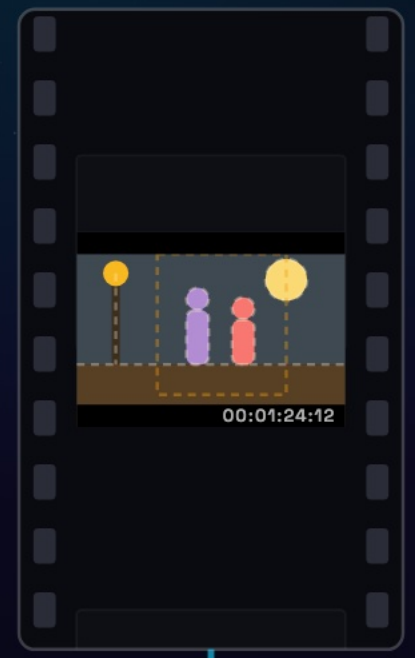
The crew uses the headset. The audience gets a normal film.



XR for the crew

| PRE-PRODUCTION | PRODUCTION | POST-PRODUCTION |
|---|---|---|
| ● Scout a scanned location in VR | ● Rehearse actors in the virtual set | ● Shoot new coverage from recordings |
| ● Try lenses, lights and blocking at 1:1 | ● Capture performance onto digital humans | ● Reframe with a virtual camera |
| ● Pull stills into the shot list | ○ Real-time previs and virtual sets | ● Review in VR, like dailies |

● Agile Lens has built this ○ What XR can do




A normal film. Any screen.

# What the Crew Sees

Click a phase. None of this ends up on screen.

Pre-production | Production | Post-production




- Shoot new coverage from a recording
- Reframe with a virtual camera
- Review it like dailies

Agile Lens: A Christmas Carol VR replay and cinematographer builds




# Scan the Real Place. Walk It Before You Fly.

Gaussian splats: a photoreal capture of a real location you can stand in

- Capture a real place in minutes, with a phone or a scanner
- Photoreal, view-dependent detail at human scale
- Walk it in VR at 1:1: scout, block, try lenses, plan shots
- Share the space with a remote director, DP or producer
- Reuse it as a virtual-production backdrop or set extension
- Lighter than a photoreal mesh; cheap to re-scan when the place changes

● Agile Lens has done this ○ What a splat can do




# What a Splat Can’t Do (Yet)

Worth knowing before you plan a shoot around one

**It’s a frozen moment**
No moving people, no running water: it records one instant

**The light is baked in**
Relighting is limited; you get the light you scanned

**Rights come first**
Scanning places and people needs permission

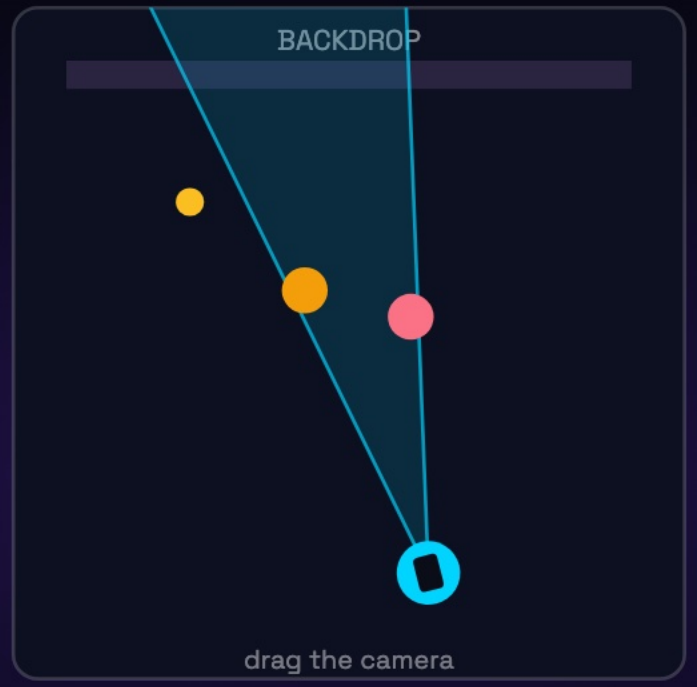
**Big files**
Standalone headsets need trimmed scans

**Young editing tools**
Cleanup and editing are still catching up

# Find the Shot Before You Fly

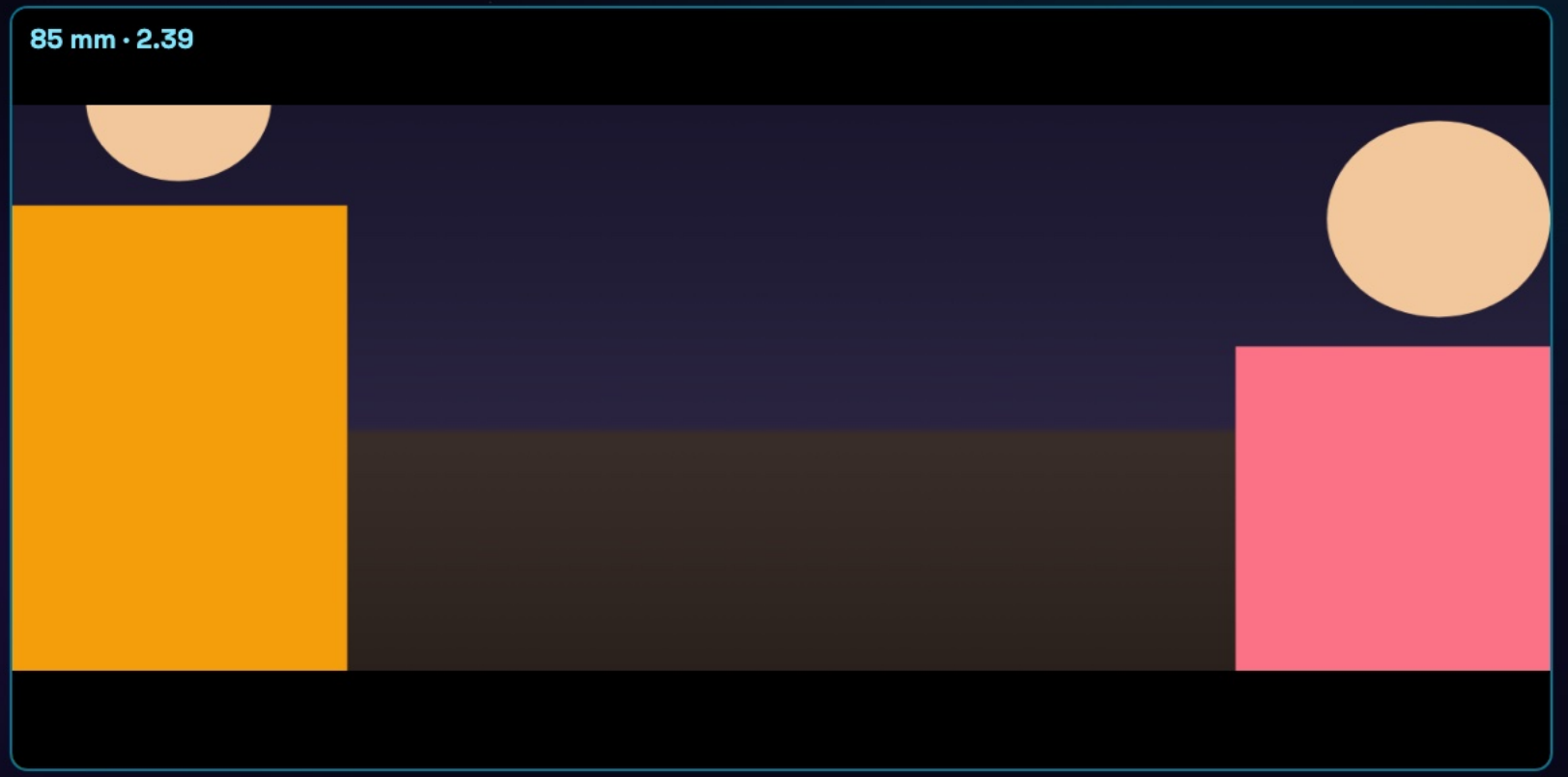
CONCEPT DEMO, BUILT FOR THIS TALK

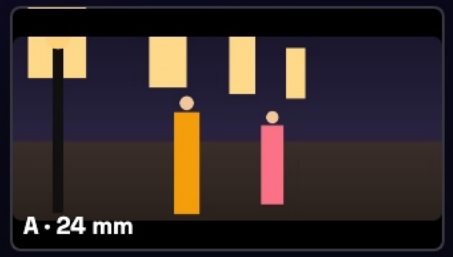
Drag the camera. Pick a lens. Take the shot.

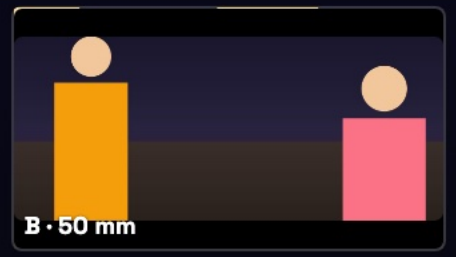



24 mm | 35 mm | 50 mm | 85 mm

2.39 mask | Take shot






# Cut Your Own Version of the Show

At our table today: a prototype built overnight for MIA



THE RECORDING

## The full show, recorded

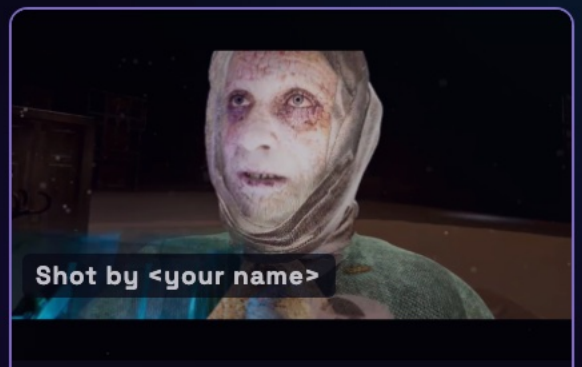
Laptop and gamepad, offline. Default scene: Dickens and Scrooge




YOU

## You are the camera operator

Fly a virtual camera through the performance; 24, 35, 50 or 85 mm




YOUR SHOT

## Your shot, credited

Add or replace a shot anywhere in the show




A NEW CUT

## A new cut of the whole show

Plays back in 2.39 with a WORKING CUT title card; survives a crash; exports

Recorded show — Your camera — Credited — Working cut



XR Network+ RSC Challenge 2025 film · Agile Lens

ACT II · TWO WAYS IN

# Royal Shakespeare Company

Virtual rehearsal tools, developed with the RSC

- Actors rehearse in a 1:1 scan of the Swan Theatre; directors follow along from a laptop
- Built with theater people, for theater people: the script stays in your hand, like paper
- An R&D grant with XR Network+, 2024–2025: tested with drama students, shown in Stratford

# Same Rehearsal, Two Rooms

Drag the line



# What Stays Normal

The audience gets a flat film. Any screen, any cinema.




*A Christmas Carol VR* · Agile Lens · performed live by Ari Tarr and Debbie Deer · adapted by Robert Barry Fleming

# XR as the Product

One story, more doors, each built on what only XR does

**ONLY XR**

- Presence
- A shared audience
- Your own viewpoint

ONE STORY

## A Christmas Carol

### ● Live in VR

Actors perform live;
the audience stands inside

Carol, five seasons, 2021–2025

### ● Trailer and clips

Flat video that sells it
on every screen

Carol 2025 trailer

### ● Replay, together

The full live show replayed;
attendees join from headsets

Carol, this December · dates TBA

### ○ Phone & web teaser

A taste on any device,
no headset needed

### ○ Festival circuit

Immersive sections at SXSW, Venice,
Cannes, Tribeca: a second audience

Carol: Raindance Immersive 2025 nominee

● Done with Carol ○ An open opportunity

ACT III · 3 / 4

# The Same Model, Other Stages.

Live performance, venues, homes and flights: audiences stepping inside.

# Heavenue

The cloud platform we built for live performance in virtual space



Lincoln Center · David Geffen Hall

# See the view before it's built.

*VR models for seating, sightline and railing decisions in David Geffen Hall's redesign, with Fisher Dachs Associates and Diamond Schmitt Architects*

# Four Seasons Private Residences, Lake Austin



In-headset capture · with DBOX and Pureblink · Agile Lens, LBE VR technologists

eVTOL air-taxi passenger simulation

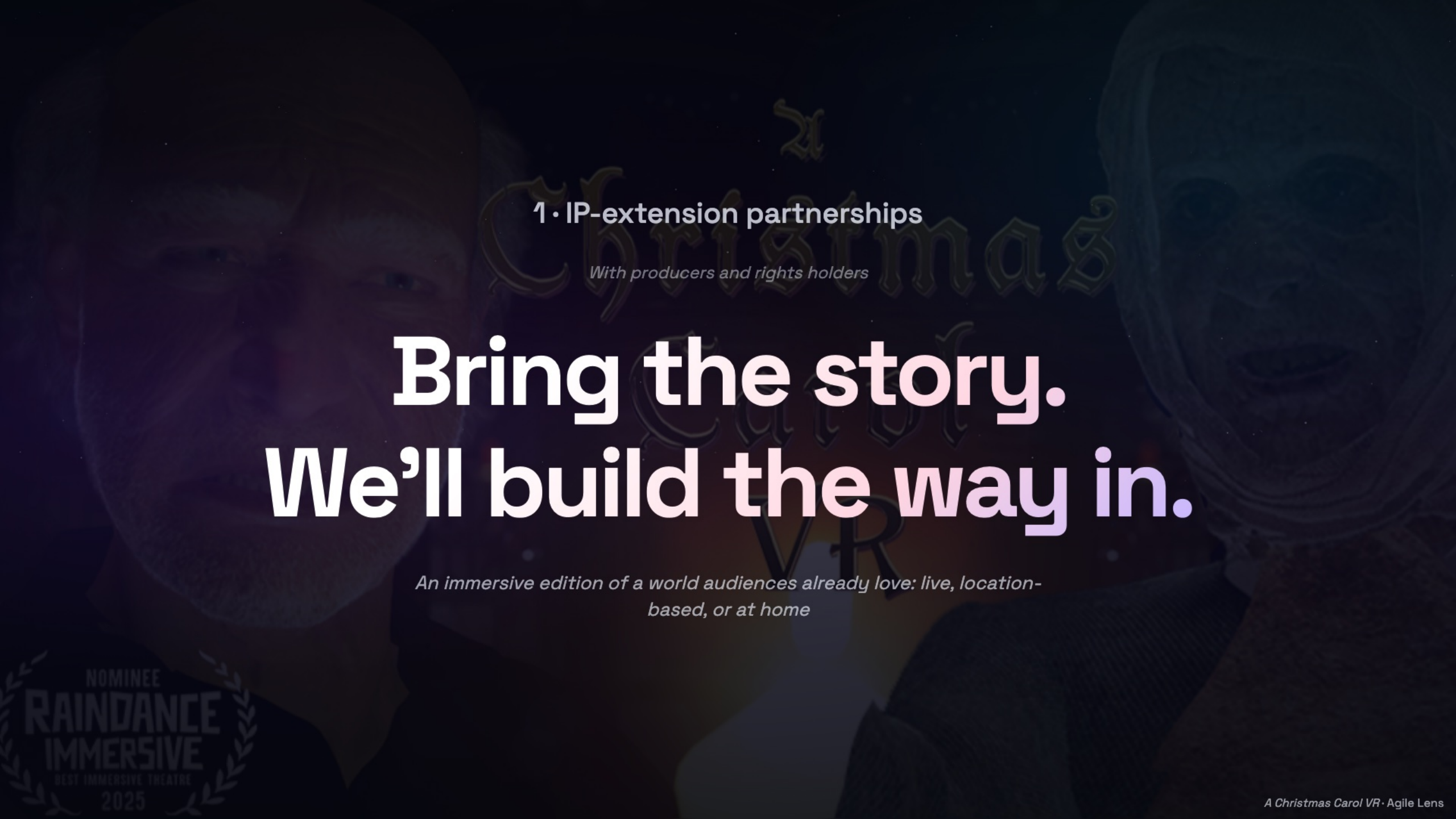
# Take the flight before it exists.

*A passenger-flight simulation for an eVTOL air-taxi company: a ride over New York*

ACT IV · 4 / 4

# What Kind of Partnerships Are We Looking For?

Two kinds. Both start with a story you already own or produce.




1 · IP-extension partnerships

*With producers and rights holders*

# Bring the story. We'll build the way in.

*An immersive edition of a world audiences already love: live, location-based, or at home*



## 2 · Co-productions from day one

*Immersive inside the financing and distribution plan*

# In the plan, not bolted on after.

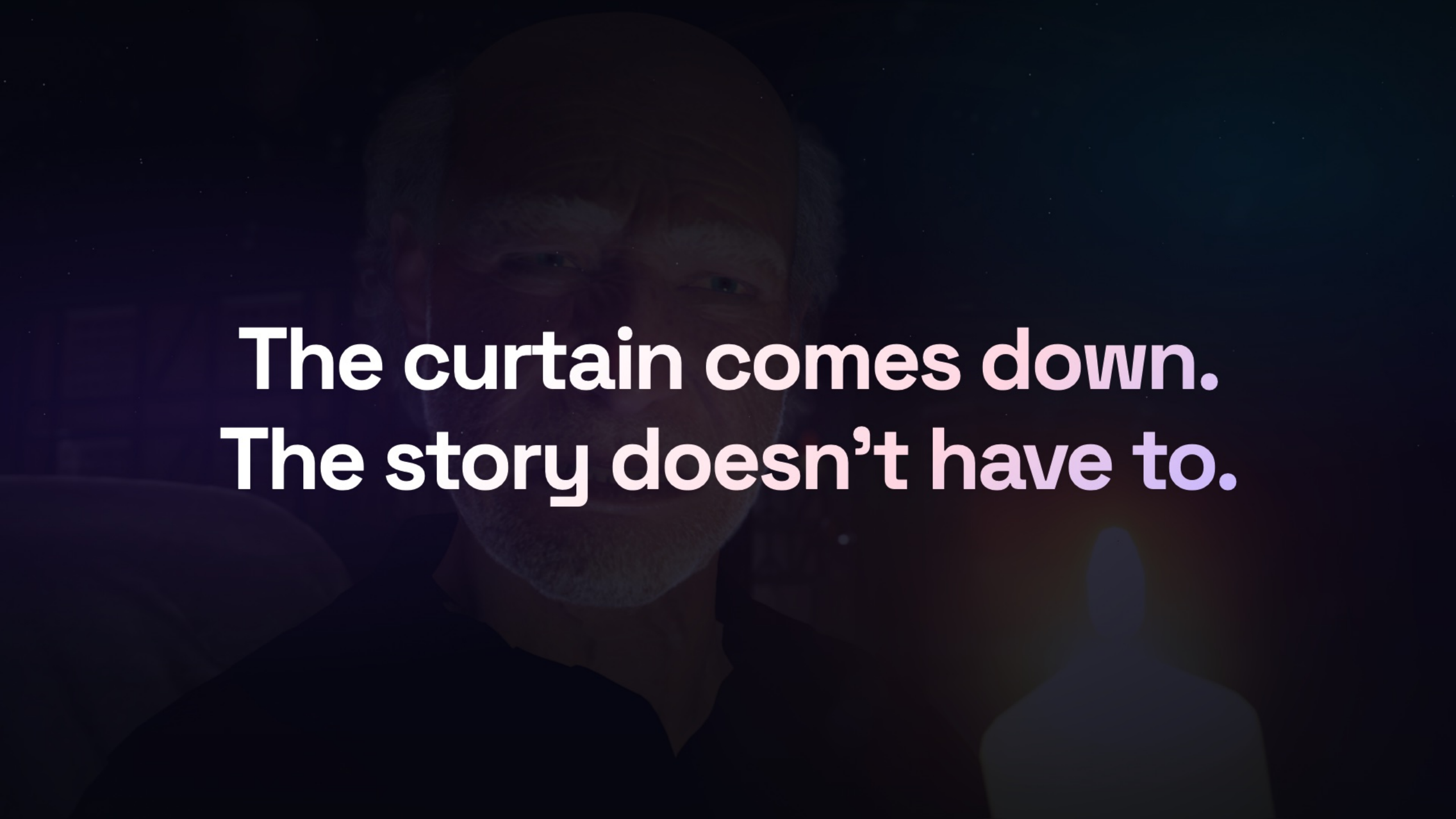
*Budgeted with the production: new windows, new audiences, assets that carry across formats*

RSC rehearsal R&D · Agile Lens

How we start

# One story.
# One audience.
# One prototype.

*A short, paid prototype of a single audience moment, then a production plan you can finance*


The curtain comes down.
The story doesn’t have to.

GRAZIE

# Let’s Build the Way In.

IP-extension partnerships · Co-productions with immersive in the plan from day one

WEB agilelens.com

FIND US Demo area, Sala Trianon

Agile Lens

Say hello

Agile Lens